

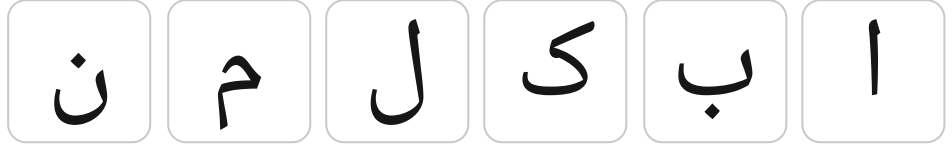
## Unit 1: The first six

پہلے چھ حرف

## 1 In this unit

Joiners vs the non-joiner alif; alif as long ā; the three short-vowel marks zabar, zer, pesh.

How long: About 3 hours for a child, 1.5 for an adult. Do 10 minutes a day, short and happy.



## 2 What to say and show, letter by letter

|   | Say                                 | How the pen moves                                             | Often mixed up with |
|---|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| ا | alif الف<br>'a' in father when long | one stroke, top to bottom                                     | lām                 |
| ب | be بے<br>'b' in bat                 | start top-right, shallow bowl leftwards, hook up; dot last    | nūn                 |
| ک | kāf کاف<br>'k' in kite              | base stroke first, right to left, then the sloping cap on top | none yet            |
| ل | lām لام<br>'l' in log               | tall stroke down, curve into the bowl                         | alif                |
| م | mīm میم<br>'m' in mat               | small loop, tail down-left                                    | none yet            |
| ن | nūn نون<br>'n' in net               | deep round bowl; dot last                                     | be                  |

## 3 How to use the sheets

1. **Trace and write:** one page per letter. Start at the dot, follow the arrow; body first, dots last.
2. **Look-alikes:** circle the same letter, then sort by dots.
3. **Join the letters:** standing letters into a joined word.
4. **Read and match:** word to meaning.
5. **Reading practice:** words, sentences, story.
6. **Dictation:** the grown-up says it, the child writes it.
7. **Unit check:** 10 questions. The answer key is the last page of the unit-check PDF; in the unit pack the keys are on the last pages.

## 4 How to check

- **Letters:** cover the sound, point to the letter, the child says it. 3 of 4 right is a pass.
- **Writing:** look at the start dot and the direction, not at how pretty it is. Right to left, body first, dots last.
- **Unit check:** 8 of 10 means go on. Under 8: redo the look-alike and trace sheets, try again tomorrow.
- **Praise effort:** "you started on the right", "good dots". One sheet a day beats five at once.

## 5 A 10-minute sitting

2 min warm-up: point to last time's letters, the child says them. 5 min the sheet of the day: say it, trace it, write it. 3 min read it back together and end on something done well.